National Health and Aging Trends Study (NHATS)

Round 3 Public Use Data – Final Release Version 3

README FILE

The NHATS R3 Public Use Final Release SAS Zip File contains 23 files (in addition to this README file). Files are described briefly below, with file names shown in **bold**.

SAS DATA FILES & FORMATS

Five SAS data files (version 9.4) are included:

NHATS_Round_3_SP_File.sas7bdat contains the sample person (SP) and the facility questionnaire (FQ) data (5,799 observations and 1,169 variables).

NHATS_Round_3_OP_File.sas7bdat contains the other person (OP) data (35,745 observations and 204 variables).

NHATS_Round_3_Tracker_File_V2.sas7bdat contains tracking information for all persons sampled for NHATS (12,411 observations and 268 variables).

NHATS_Round_3_MetNonMet.sas7bdat contains metro/nonmetro geographic information for all persons who completed an NHATS interview (5,799 observations and 2 variables).

NHATS_Round_3_Int_Inc_Imp_File.sas7bdat contains the interval income imputation data (5,799 observations and 23 variables).

PROC FORMAT statements are provided in

NHATS_Round_3_Combined_PROC_FORMAT_Statement.sas for the first three files combined,

NHATS_Round_3_MetNonMet_PROC_FORMAT.sas for metro/nonmetro file, and

NHATS_Round_3_Int_Inc_Imp_PROC_FORMAT.sas for interval income imputation file. (Users who prefer to disable the formats may use the statement OPTIONS NOFMTERR.)

ASCII FIXED FORMAT TEXT FILES

Five ASCII files are included: **NHATS_Round_3_SP_File.txt**, **NHATS_Round_3_OP_File.txt**, **NHATS_Round_3_Tracker_File_V2.txt**, **NHATS_Round_3_MetNonMet.txt**, and **NHATS_Round_3_Int_Inc_Imp_File.txt**.

Users may create their own SAS file by reading in the ASCII files with the provided SAS program files: **NHATS_Round_3_SP_READ.sas**, **NHATS_Round_3_OP_READ.sas**, **NHATS_Round_3_Tracker_READ_V2.sas**, **NHATS_Round_3_MetNonMet_READ.sas**, and **NHATS_Round_3_Int_Inc_Imp_Read.sas**.

Each SAS program contains four sections: (1) a section setting up the pre-defined formats, (2) an input statement, which identifies the starting position of each variable in the ASCII file, (3) a section mapping variables to specific formats, and (4) a section that provides descriptive variable labels, which can be mapped back to the Instrument. Alternatively, users may adapt these SAS programs as needed to import the ASCII data into other software packages.

CODEBOOK FREQUENCIES

Frequencies (and means for many continuous variables) are included in:

NHATS_Round_3_SP_Frequencies.pdf

NHATS_Round_3_OP_Frequencies.pdf

NHATS_Round_3_Tracker_Frequencies_V2.pdf

NHATS_Round_3_MetNonMet_Frequencies.pdf

NHATS_Round_3_Int_Inc_Imp_Frequencies.pdf

For each variable, the variable name and label is included along with value labels and associated numeric values.

ADDITIONAL DOCUMENTATION

Additional documentation is available on the NHATS website (www.NHATS.org) and includes: the Round 3 Instruments (annotated with variable names and labels), User Guide, Crosswalk between instrument items and codebooks, crosswalk of changes between the Round 3 Beta release and Round 3 Final release, and various technical papers.

QUESTIONS OR COMMENTS

If you have questions or concerns that are not addressed here or in documentation found at www.NHATS.org, please feel free to contact us at NHATSdata@westat.com.